



#DecadeToDecade



Hope and Rural Aid Foundation

HARAF MONTHLY BULLETIN

February 2026 Edition



INTRODUCTION

Hope and Rural Aid Foundation (HARAF) is a humanitarian, non-profit, and non-governmental organization committed to improving the lives of vulnerable and underserved communities. Established in 2011, HARAF has built a strong track record of delivering impactful interventions across key sectors, including livelihoods, health, education, and community development.

In 2016, the organization was formally registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) of the Federal Republic of Nigeria under registration number CAC/IT/85536, further strengthening its institutional credibility and compliance with national regulatory standards.

Driven by a vision of sustainable development and human dignity, HARAF continues to design and implement innovative, community-centered programs that foster resilience, empower individuals, and promote inclusive growth.

HARAF PRESENCE

Adamawa, Borno, Yobe, Sokoto

THEMATIC AREAS

Health

Education

Livelihood

**Mainstreaming
Protection**



Reaching the Unreached without Borders

Training of Community PALS Facilitators

Under the Thrive and Rise Project, funded by the Hilton Foundation, HARAF conducted a five-day training for Community PALS Facilitators at the HARAF Conference Hall, bringing together 15 participants from Gurin, Fufore, Girei A, Girei B, and Jabi Lamba communities.

The training strengthened facilitators' capacity to effectively deliver Parenting and Adolescent Life Skills (PALS) sessions, while enhancing their understanding of safeguarding, child protection, gender-based violence prevention, facilitation techniques, adolescent sexual and reproductive health, and the use of MEAL tools for program monitoring and accountability.

Through interactive sessions, group exercises, and practical demonstrations, participants gained the knowledge and skills required to facilitate community-based life skills and parenting sessions, promote safe learning environments, and effectively track program outcomes. The training successfully equipped community facilitators to lead the 13-week PALS sessions, supporting adolescents and caregivers to improve wellbeing, strengthen family relationships, and build positive life skills within their communities.



Safeguarding Session for PALS Participants

In February 2026, HARAF SRH-R Hilton Project team, with support from the BMZ SRH Officer, facilitated safeguarding sessions for the first cohort of PALS participants across five communities in Girei and Fufore LGAs, reaching 200 participants, including 100 parents and 100 adolescents.

The sessions strengthened participants' understanding of HARAF's safeguarding policy, roles and responsibilities, and reporting mechanisms to ensure a safe and protective environment for all program participants. Key discussions covered child safeguarding, prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse (PSEA), the "Do No Harm" principle, and adherence to HARAF's Code of Conduct. Participants were also guided on mandatory reporting procedures, responding to disclosures of abuse, and maintaining confidentiality.

The engagement increased awareness of safeguarding responsibilities, strengthened understanding of reporting pathways, and reinforced a child-centered approach in program implementation. HARAF remains committed to integrating safeguarding principles across all program activities to ensure the protection and wellbeing of children and vulnerable groups.



Life Skills Sessions – PALS Program

The HARAF SRHR team, in collaboration with community PALS facilitators, successfully rolled out the first Parenting and Adolescent Life Skills (PALS) sessions across Fufore, Gurin, Girei 1 & 2, and Jabi Lamba communities under the Hilton Foundation-funded Thrive and Rise Project. The sessions targeted both adolescents and parents/caregivers, aiming to strengthen life skills, promote informed health choices, and improve overall wellbeing.

During the Adolescent Session (**Module 1: Ourselves and Our Community**), participants were introduced to the program through interactive activities and games that encouraged engagement and peer interaction. Adolescents reflected on their personal learning goals and were introduced to the program's objective of providing a safe space to learn, share experiences, and build life skills.

Similarly, the Parenting Session (Module 1: Being a Parent) focused on building a supportive group environment for parents and caregivers. Participants established group ground rules, set personal parenting goals, and were encouraged to foster open communication with their adolescent children throughout the program.

Overall, the sessions recorded strong participation and enthusiasm, successfully laying the foundation for the 13-week PALS program by fostering trust, promoting family dialogue, and creating a safe and inclusive learning environment for adolescents and caregivers.



Reaching the Unreached without Barrier

Livelihood

The HARAF Livelihood Team, under the Thrive and Rise Project, in collaboration with local Agricultural Extension Workers, successfully delivered comprehensive training sessions throughout February 2026 across Fufore and Girei Livelihood Incubation Centres. The training provided structured, practical, and highly participatory capacity-building across key agricultural value chains, including fish farming, crop and vegetable production, goat rearing, and poultry production.

The sessions effectively strengthened participants' technical competencies, with a strong focus on enterprise establishment, productivity enhancement, resource efficiency, and disease prevention. Participants gained hands-on skills in site selection, soil and seed management, feeding and water management, livestock health, biosecurity, record-keeping, and basic financial management, all tailored to smallholder farming systems.

Overall, the intervention significantly improved participants' readiness to establish and sustain viable livelihood enterprises, 90 participants actively and consistently engaged throughout the training period.



Training on Goat production and Crop/Vegetables with project participants in Fufore LIC



Recap session with fish production participants at Girei LIC and Crop production participants ploughing rice field at Girei LIC



Okra planting session with Project participants in Fufore LIC and a Poultry production Session with project participants at Girei LIC



Training on Poultry production by Extension Agent with project participants and Fish Pond Management with Project participants in Fufore LIC in Fufore LIC



**Training on fish sorting and feeding with project participants in Fufore LIC
Applying organic pest control (Neem leaves) to the vegetable bed with project participants in Fufore LIC**



Training on Goat Production with project participants in Fufore/Girei LIC

Community Based Complaints Mechanism (CFM) and PSEA Training - Dikwa

A comprehensive three-day Community-Based Complaints Mechanism (CFM) and Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA) training was successfully conducted from 4th to 6th February 2026 in Dikwa LGA, with 20 participants (10 males and 10 females), including CFM focal points and key project staff. The training strengthened participants' capacity on Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP), safe and confidential complaint management, and the application of survivor-centred approaches. Using participatory and practical methodologies, participants enhanced their skills in complaint documentation, referral pathways, data protection, and ethical conduct. Overall, the training significantly improved confidence and competence in managing complaints professionally, reinforced safeguarding systems, and strengthened community trust and compliance with PSEA standards.

Deployment of Mobile Health Team (MHT) and RCCE Team

The Mobile Health Team (MHT) and Risk Communication and Community Engagement (RCCE) Team were successfully deployed during the reporting month to the hard-to-reach communities of Masarmari and Fulatari in Dikwa LGA, significantly expanding access to lifesaving primary healthcare services. The MHT delivered essential health interventions, including outpatient consultations, integrated management of childhood illnesses, case referrals, and disease surveillance, reaching a total of 3,708 individuals.

In parallel, the RCCE team conducted participatory health education sessions on key issues such as cholera prevention, malaria control, safe health-seeking behaviours, and maternal health, reaching 2,534 community members. The integrated approach effectively improved access to healthcare, strengthened community awareness, and promoted positive health practices, contributing to reduced barriers and enhanced health outcomes among vulnerable populations.

Health Facility Support – Kasugula PHC

Support to Kasugula Primary Health Care (PHC) facility in Dikwa LGA was effectively strengthened during the reporting month through the deployment of additional project-supported health personnel, enhancing service delivery capacity and ensuring continuity of quality care. The facility provided comprehensive primary healthcare services, reaching 542 individuals through outpatient consultations, including management of common illnesses, IMCI services, and referrals for complicated cases.

Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) services were significantly reinforced, with 375 antenatal care visits, 115 safe deliveries, 112 postnatal care consultations, and 28 family planning services recorded. The distribution of clean delivery kits to all delivering mothers further promoted safe childbirth practices, reduced infection risks, and strengthened confidence in facility-based deliveries.

Overall, the intervention substantially improved access to quality healthcare, enhanced maternal and child health outcomes, and reinforced community trust in formal health services.



Distribution of a Clean Delivery Kit to support safe delivery at Kasugula PHC, Dikwa LGA.



Mobile Health Team outreach providing primary healthcare services to Masarmari Camp in Dikwa LGA.



Mobile Health Team Outreach Sessions and Risk Communication Community Engagement Sessions in Fulatari Dikwa LGA



Risk Communication Community Engagement Sessions in Masarmari Dikwa LGA

CFM Team engaging directly with beneficiaries to receive feedback and strengthen accountability to affected populations



CCCM TRAINING IN MADAGALI

Following comprehensive stakeholder engagement, the CCCM team successfully delivered targeted training sessions for community members in Shuwa and Gulak, significantly strengthening local understanding of CCCM core principles, governance structures, and accountability mechanisms. The initiative effectively built community capacity for camp coordination, fostered inclusive participation, and reinforced coordination with humanitarian actors.

Key topics covered included:

- ⊗ **CCCM core principles, objectives, and key terminology (IDPs, returnees, host communities)**
- ⊗ **Roles and responsibilities of community leaders and committees.**
- ⊗ **Community participation, governance, and coordination with humanitarian actors.**
- ⊗ **Complaint and Feedback Mechanisms (CFM) and reporting channels**
- ⊗ **Protection, inclusion, and safeguarding of vulnerable groups**

Participants demonstrated strong engagement through interactive discussions, scenario-based exercises, and group activities, translating knowledge into practical application of camp governance and accountability frameworks. The training strengthened collaboration among returnees, IDPs, and host communities, reinforced community ownership of CCCM processes, and equipped participants to actively promote inclusive, accountable, and effective camp management.



Capacity strengthening of stakeholders on Child Protection (CP), Gender-Based Violence (GBV), and case management, community awareness initiatives.

HARAF NHF project team “Enhancing Safety and Dignity of Displaced Populations Through Targeted Protection Services, CCCM Support, and Dignified NFIs/Cash Assistance in Madagali” successfully conducted Training on Child Protection (CP), Gender-Based Violence (GBV), and case management in February 2026 across Shuwa, Gulak, and Duhu communities in Madagali LGA. The sessions targeted key community stakeholders, including traditional leaders, women, youth, persons with disabilities, and older persons, with a total of 34 participants (7 women and 27 men). The training strengthened stakeholders’ understanding of core protection issues, including CP, GBV, case management services, and NFI support components, while enhancing their capacity to identify, refer, and support vulnerable cases within their communities.

In addition, community-wide awareness and sensitization activities were carried out, focusing on GBV, child protection, neglect, and sexual exploitation and abuse (SEA) reaching about 824 (63 male and 761 female). These sessions improved community knowledge on recognizing protection risks and accessing appropriate referral pathways for case management services. Overall, the intervention strengthened community-based protection systems, improved awareness, and promoted timely reporting and response to protection concerns.

Enhancing Safety and Dignity of Displaced Populations, 34 Participants (27 Male, 7 Female)



Awareness & Sensitization 824 participants (63 Male, 761 Female)



Training of 120 CAHWs/VPPs on Nutrition (ASF)

HARAF, in partnership with Propcom+, successfully delivered a two-day capacity-building training for 120 Community Animal Health Workers (CAHWs) and Veterinary Paraprofessionals (VPPs), strengthening their ability to integrate Animal Source Food (ASF) nutrition messaging into routine livestock service delivery. The training strategically leveraged the trusted role of frontline animal health providers to address low awareness of ASF benefits and improve dietary diversity among livestock-producing communities.

The sessions equipped participants with practical knowledge on the nutritional value of ASF highlighting its critical role in improving maternal and child health—and provided hands-on approaches to embed nutrition messaging into vaccination campaigns, farm visits, and advisory services. Participants were also introduced to simplified communication tools to enhance community engagement and promote behaviour change.

As a result, CAHWs and VPPs are now better positioned to serve as nutrition champions, driving increased awareness and consumption of ASF at household level. The training has strengthened the linkage between livestock production and nutrition outcomes, with clear action plans developed to sustain integration of nutrition messaging in field activities, ultimately contributing to improved dietary practices and community health outcomes.

Commencement of Radio Jingle Airing on NAS FM 89.9

HARAF, in partnership with PROPCOM+, has successfully launched the airing of targeted radio jingles on NAS FM 89.9 to promote livestock production and access to veterinary services across Adamawa State. This strategic initiative leverages radio's wide reach and strong rural listenership to drive awareness, knowledge uptake, and demand for quality animal health services among farmers and pastoral communities.

To ensure effective audience engagement, the jingles are broadcast in Hausa at 6:45 AM capturing farmers at the start of daily activities and in Fulfulde at 6:45 PM reaching pastoral households after grazing hours. This dual-language, time-targeted approach guarantees inclusivity and maximizes message penetration.

The jingles are aired twice daily for 20 days each month over a five-month period, ensuring consistent messaging, sustained engagement, and measurable impact across target communities.





Youth Learn, Earn and Prosper in the Lake Chad Region

In February 2026, the team successfully implemented targeted adolescent-focused interventions across Mafa and Damboa LGAs, delivering school outreaches and facility-based sensitization sessions on STI prevention, life skills and decision-making, harmful traditional practices, and sexual and reproductive rights.

School outreaches conducted in both LGAs strengthened adolescents' knowledge of STI transmission, prevention, and the importance of early testing and treatment, while also improving awareness of available services at Primary Health Care facilities. Participants demonstrated increased confidence in accessing care and seeking support.

Complementary awareness sessions at PHC facilities equipped adolescents with critical life skills, enabling informed decision-making on health, relationships, and personal wellbeing. Discussions on harmful traditional practices particularly early and forced marriage and female genital mutilation enhanced understanding of associated health and protection risks and encouraged adolescents to seek support and resist harmful norms. A total of 396 (75 male and 321 female) community members were reached through this initiative.

Additionally, sessions on sexual and reproductive rights reinforced adolescents' awareness of their rights to access quality health services, make informed decisions, and receive care with confidentiality, dignity, and respect.

Overall, the interventions significantly improved knowledge, influenced positive behavioural change, and strengthened adolescents' access to and utilization of essential health and protection services across both LGAs.

Life Skills Sessions – Cohorts 11 & 12

In February 2026, the Life Skills Programme for Cohorts 11 and 12 was successfully implemented across Mafa and Damboa LGAs in Borno State, and Girei and Fufere LGAs in Adamawa State, following a rigorous selection and verification process targeting vulnerable adolescents, including out-of-school youth, adolescent mothers, GBV survivors, and adolescents with special needs.

A total of 288 adolescents and 288 parents participated in structured sessions across Kaleri, Simari, Alkaleri, Shuwari, Girei, Ribadu, Jabbi-Lamba, and Malabu communities. The sessions established safe and inclusive spaces while strengthening adolescents' ability to set personal goals, build support networks, manage emotions, cope with stress, and develop positive peer and adult relationships. Participants also acquired practical skills to resist negative peer pressure and identify safe and healthy relationships, including understanding consent and responding to harmful behaviours.

In parallel, parenting sessions strengthened caregivers' capacity to support adolescent development. Parents and caregivers enhanced their skills in positive communication, stress management, problem-solving, and adolescent sexual and reproductive health, while promoting gender-sensitive, non-violent, and supportive family environments.

Overall, the programme significantly enhanced adolescents' psychosocial wellbeing and decision-making capacity, while reinforcing family support systems and fostering safer, more enabling environments for adolescent development.

Sexual and Reproductive Health Service (SRHR) Delivery

In February 2026, the programme strengthened adolescent and youth access to quality sexual and reproductive health (SRH) services across Damboa, Mafa, Girei and Fufore LGAs of Borno and Adamawa states through targeted commodity distribution, supportive supervision, and service delivery.

Essential SRH commodities were successfully distributed to Gurin and Girei PHCCs, improving the availability of critical supplies and enhancing the quality of care for adolescents and young people. Supportive supervision was also conducted across Malabu, Girei B, and Gurin PHCCs to ensure adherence to clinical standards and the provision of appropriate, youth-friendly services.

Across PHC facilities of Simari, Alkalari, Girei B, Malabu, Ribadu, Jabbi Lamba, and Gurin adolescents and youths accessed a wide range of services, including antenatal care, safe deliveries and postnatal care, family planning, STI treatment, and counseling. These services were delivered by trained healthcare providers under the Adolescent and Youth Friendly Health Services (AYFHS) approach, ensuring a safe, confidential, and supportive environment.

The intervention recorded strong service uptake, particularly in antenatal care, STI treatment, family planning, and counseling, demonstrating increased awareness and utilization of available services among adolescents and young people reaching about 2985 (2417 female and 568 male) participants across communities.

Overall, the integrated approach significantly improved access to quality SRH services, strengthened health system responsiveness, and contributed to better health outcomes and wellbeing for adolescents and youths across the targeted communities.





HEAD OFFICE

Mallamre Quarters,
Beside UNHCR Office,
Jimeta-Yola, Adamawa State.

Maiduguri Sub-Office

Gombole Road,
After Capital School,
Before Giwa Barracks,
Maiduguri, Borno State.

Yobe Sub-Office

Malari Layout,
Gubja Road,
Damaturu, Yobe State.

Sokoto Sub-Office

Umaru Muh'd Housing State Unit,
Yauri Flat, Beside Arewa Suya Spot,
Sokoto, Sokoto State.

Michika Sub-Office

No. 3, Ziradzala Store,
Opp. Local Government Secretariat,
Michika, Adamawa State.

www.haraf.org.ng

info@haraf.org.ng

[haraf_org](https://www.instagram.com/haraf_org)



[@Haraf_org](https://twitter.com/Haraf_org)

[HARAF.ORG](https://www.facebook.com/HARAF.ORG)

[hope-and-rural-aid-foundation](https://www.instagram.com/haraf_org)